

Te Tauga o Mea Katoa i Luga i Nanumea

Te mata o muna tenei e faka tūtonu ki he faifaiga tāua o te 'gana Nanumea i tauga o vaega o mea valevale. E i ai ailoa muna fakatūmau mo tauga o mea valevale e mafai o faka igoa ki "vaega o tauga" ("counting categories"), me e mafai hoki o faka igoa ki he vaega hekeheke o mataimuna. Pelā mo te tauga o tino, atu, mo niu, kae uke ake hoki mea valevale kolā e heke hoki te tauga i te 'gana Nanumea. Ai ā e heke i ai vaega tauga penei mai tauga māhani loa pelā 1, 2, 3? Tino māhala kolā e fakamau e lātou 'gana hekeheke e molimau mai me i te lahiga o 'gana i te lalolagi (kae hē ko 'gana katoa) e i ai ailoa he vaega kolā e hekeheke a vaega tauga. Ai ā lā e hē fakaaogā te tauga māhani loa mo mea katoa?

E hē ai he tali māmā ki ai, me ko te faitega ailoa o te 'gana tenei koa māhani tātou ki ai. Ko te "faiga lā e tātou ailoa." E pelā ailoa te faitu tenā, e i ai hoki ni fesili mo uiga fakafofo e moe ikonei. Pelā mo vaega kolā a tauga hekeheke, e māhani o fakaaogā mo mea i 'tou olaga kolā e tāua ki faiga mo iloga. I te atu fenua Tuvalu mo Nanumea hoki a vaega o te olaga māhani e tāua 'ki (fakatino mai vaega tauga hekeheke konei) e pelā mo tino, niu, ika tāua pelā mo atu mo hahave, paikea, tupa mo ika tolotolo ake, lau mo ato fale, mo mea pāpā ake pelā mo epa, papa, tīpola, pelā hoki mo kolokolo mo kafa, mo mea ake hoki.

Mai lalo e tuhi i ai a vaega tauga faka mataimanu faka Nanumea koa mauagina nei e mātou. E fakafoofogina me e i ai mataimanu e tahi ikonei e fakaaogā mo vaega o mea e uke. Ni ā mea e papau mana tuku fakatahi o tau? Pelā mo te tauga o atu, e lua e teaoa e papau mo niu e lua, kae e heke a mataimanu ake. Mo tauga o niu mo manu, te fakaotiga "gafua" e fakaopopo ki mataimanu pelā 1-9. Mo tauga o tino mo atu, e kāmata te muna e tatau mo "tino," pelā "tino tolu" (30). Kae e hē pau mo tauga o niu, me ko 30 a niu e "tolugapulupulu!" Te vaega o te 'gana Nanumea e fakaaogā mo te tauga o mea e fakafoofogina kae e faigatā hoki.

He mea e gali e māhani o fai ko te fakaaogāga o muna kāmata me fakaoti me fakatino e lātou he

Counting Categories in Nanumea

The focus of this chapter is a feature of our language which deals with the special ways we count certain items. The special words used to count different types of objects are sometimes called "counting categories," or they may be called "specialized numerals." For example, special counting words familiar to all of us are used for people, skipjack tuna, and coconuts, but there are also many other categories of things for which we have special words for counting as well. Why do we have these ways to count just some things in our world, while almost everything else is counted using the general system, 1, 2, 3, etc? Linguists, the specialists who have made the study of language their life's work, have shown us that many of the world's languages (but not all of them) have these special categories for some types of counting. Why not simply use the general way of counting, for everything?

There is no easy answer since, of course, this is just the way our language has come down to us. It is "the way we do it." However, beyond this obvious truth lie some interesting questions. For instance, special forms of counting seem to apply especially to the areas of life that are particularly important in that culture. For Nanumea and Tuvalu, these culturally important areas of life (as shown by our having counting categories for them) include people, coconuts, fish such as skipjack tuna and flying fish, crabs and other crawling "fish", lau for thatched roofs and other "flat" things such as epa, papa and tīpola, rolled or braided cord, and a few other things.

In the sections below we list the special counting numerals we know about for Nanumea. An interesting feature is that some of the special numbers are used for more than one category of object. Which objects in the lists below seem to cluster together, based on having similar counting systems? Notice that two atu and two niu are both counted as teaoa, but the other numbers for those objects are not the same. For coconuts and birds, the suffix –gafua is added to ordinary numbers for 1-9. For people, birds and atu tuna, the prefix tino– is added before some ordinary numbers (such as in tino tolu, 30) --- but this is not done for coconuts, where the same number is tolougapulupulu! Our special counting language is wonderfully complex.

Another interesting feature of our counting system is that many of the prefix or suffix words used refer to

vaega o te mea e 'tau: tona tua, tona mata, me ko tona papāga. Atu lā ko kautama Nanumea fakamuli koa fiafia lātou o tauloto faka 'lei a vaega o tauga hekeheke konei. Kae ko tātou nei, e hē ai he mea ake, nā ko te iloa o tau kae fakaaogā mataimuna konei.

A 'gana katoa i Tuvalu e i ai ailoa oloutou vaega tauga o mea. Koa talitonu mātou me e i ai hekehekega mai fenua ki fenua (e hē pau olotou vaega tauga katoa), kae e i ai ni hekega hoki mai tino ki tino. I hē tahi o te vaega tauga mai lalo konei (hahave), e pelā me e lua vaega tauga e māhani i ai. E talitonu tātou me i kautama fakamuli nei e hē iloa tonu a lātou a tauga hekeheke konei – kae e hē iloa tonu me pehea te mafulifuligina a te fakaaogā o mataimuna konei. I tauga pelā mo tauga o tino, e 'tau ailoa o fakaaogā ke tonu ailoa te fakaaogā o te gana, kae pelā mo tauga o mea ake (pelā mo paikea mo tupa) atu lā e hē loko fakaaogā tele.

some aspect of the item itself: its back (tua), eye (mata), flatness (kau). Perhaps a member of our younger generation will become interested and study this counting system in depth. The rest of us just need to learn the system and use it.

All Tuvaluan dialects have counting categories. There seem to be some differences from island to island (not every counting system in Tuvalu is identical), and there may even be variation from person to person. For at least one category (flying fish), there seem to be two different counting systems. We suspect that younger people today have less knowledge of these counting categories than do older people – but we are not sure how use of these special numerals is changing. Some of them, as in counting people, still seem obligatory (not to use them makes the language sound "wrong"), while others (such as counting paikea or tupa) may be less used.

Tino "tino"

1-9: toko tahi, toko lua, toko tolu, toko fā, etc.
 10: tinogafulu
 11-19: tinogafulu mo te toko tahi, tinogafulu mo te toko lua, etc.
 20-90: tino lua, tinotolu, tinofā, etc.
 100: tino lau
 200-900: lua lau tino, tino tolu lau tino, tino fā lau tino, etc.
 1000: tino afe tino
 10,000: tino gafulu afe tino

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 100: tino lau
 200-900: lua lau tino, tino tolu lau tino, tino fā lau tino, etc.
 1000: tino afe tino
 10,000: tino gafulu afe tino

Atu (mo tavatava hoki)

1: tahi (te taloaga)
 2: teaoa
 3-9: tolugafua, fāgafua, limagafua, etc.
 10: tefui
 11-19: tefui mā tahi, tefui mo te teaoa, tefui mo te tolugafua, etc.
 20: tekau
 24: tekau mā fā
 30-90: tinotolu, tinofā, tinolima, etc.

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 20: tekau
 24: tekau mā fā
 30-90: tinotolu, tinofā, tinolima, etc.

100: lau (kae e taku atu "katoa" mana fai e lau te vaka)

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Takuo mo Pāla "mata"

1: tahi takuo
2: lua takuo
3-9: tolu, fā, lima etc. takuo
10: matāgafulu takuo
11-19: matāgafulu mā tahi, matāgafulu mā lua etc.
20: mata lua
30-90: mata tolu, matafā, mata lima etc.
100: mata telau
110: mata telau mo te matāgafulu

Takuo mo Pāla "mata"

1: tahi takuo
2: lua takuo
3-9: tolu, fā, lima etc. takuo
10: matāgafulu takuo
11-19: matāgafulu mā tahi, matāgafulu mā lua etc.
20: mata lua
30-90: mata tolu, matafā, mata lima etc.
100: mata telau
110: mata telau mo te matāgafulu

Hahave "mata"

1-9: mataimanu māhani, tahi, lua, tolu, fā, etc.
10: matāgafulu
11-19: matāgafulu mā tahi, matāgafulu mā lua, etc.
20-90: mata lua, mata tolu, mata fā, mata lima, etc.
100: mata telau
110: mata telau mo te matāgafulu, me ko matāgafulu te kaulualau
120: mata telau mo te matalua, me ko matalua a te kaulua galau
130: mata telau mo te matatolu, etc., me ko matatolu a te kaulua galau, etc.
200: kaulua galau
210: kaulua galau mo te matāgafulu, me ko matāgafulu a te kautolu galau
220: kaulua galau mo te matalua, etc., me ko matalua a te kautolu galau (220)
300-500: kautolu galau, kaufā galau, kaulima galau.

Hahave "mata"

1-9: mataimanu māhani, tahi, lua, tolu, fā, etc.
10: matāgafulu
11-19: matāgafulu mā tahi, matāgafulu mā lua, etc.
20-90: mata lua, mata tolu, mata fā, mata lima, etc.
100: mata telau
110: mata telau mo te matāgafulu, me ko matāgafulu te kaulualau
120: mata telau mo te matalua, me ko matalua a te kaulua galau
130: mata telau mo te matatolu, etc., me ko matatolu a te kaulua galau, etc.
200: kaulua galau
210: kaulua galau mo te matāgafulu, me ko matāgafulu a te kautolu galau
220: kaulua galau mo te matalua, etc., me ko matalua a te kautolu galau (220)
300-500: kautolu galau, kaufā galau, kaulima galau.

Manu Lele (pelā mo katafa, gogo, akiaki, lupe etc.)

1: tahi (te taloaga)
2: lua
3-9: tolu, fā, lima, etc.
10: tinogafulu

Manu Lele / Flying Birds (e.g. katafa, gogo, akiaki, lupe etc.)

1: tahi (te taloaga)
2: lua
3-9: tolu, fā, lima, etc.
10: tinogafulu

11-19: tinogafulu mā tahi, lua, tolu, etc.

20: tekau

24: tekau mā fā

30-90: tinotolu, tinofā, tinolima, etc.

100: lau

110: lau mo te tinogafulu

11-19: tinogafulu mā tahi, lua, tolu, etc.

20: tekau

24: tekau mā fā

30-90: tinotolu, tinofā, tinolima, etc.

100: lau

110: lau mo te tinogafulu

Paikea (pelā hoki mo tupa, ū, kaviki, kalemiha, matamea, paka) "tua"

1-9: mataimanu māhani, tahi, lua, tolu, fā, etc.

10-19: tuagafulu (10), tuagafulu mā tahi (11) etc.

20-90: tualua (20), tuatolu, tuafā, etc.

99: tuaiva mā iva

100: tuatelau

200-900: tualuagalau, tuatolugalau, etc.

Paikea (also tupa, ū, kaviki, kalemiha, matamea, paka) "tua"

1-9: mataimanu māhani, tahi, lua, tolu, fā, etc.

10-19: tuagafulu (10), tuagafulu mā tahi (11) etc.

20-90: tualua (20), tuatolu, tuafā, etc.

99: tuaiva mā iva

100: tuatelau

200-900: tualuagalau, tuatolugalau, etc.

Niu (pelā hoki mo pī, u'tanu)

1: tahi

2: teaoa

3-9: tolu gafua, fā gafua, lima gafua, etc.

10-19: tefui, tefui mā tahi, tefui mā te teaoa, tefui mo te tolu gafua, etc.

20: teāmoga

20-29: teāmoga mo te teaoa, teāmoga mo te tolugafua, etc.

30-90: tolugapulupulu, fāgapulupulu, limagapulupulu, etc.

100: tefua

200-900: luagatefua, tolugatefua, fāgatefua, etc.

600-900: onogatefua, fitugatefua, valugatefua, ivagatefua

1000: moikao

2000-9000: lua moikao, tolu moikao, etc.

10,000: mano

Niu / Coconuts (also pī, u'tanu)

1: tahi

2: teaoa

3-9: tolu gafua, fā gafua, lima gafua, etc.

10-19: tefui, tefui mā tahi, tefui mā te teaoa, tefui mo te tolu gafua, etc.

20: teāmoga

20-29: teāmoga mo te teaoa, teāmoga mo te tolugafua, etc.

30-90: tolugapulupulu, fāgapulupulu, limagapulupulu, etc.

100: tefua

200-900: luagatefua, tolugatefua, fāgatefua, etc.

600-900: onogatefua, fitugatefua, valugatefua, ivagatefua

1000: moikao

2000-9000: lua moikao, tolu moikao, etc.

10,000: mano

Pulaka, Talo "mata"

1-9: tahi, lua, tolu, etc.

10: matāgafulu

Pulaka, Talo "mata"

1-9: tahi, lua, tolu, etc.

10: matāgafulu

11-19: matāgafulu mā tahi, matāgafulu mā lua, mā tolu, etc.

20-90: matalua, matatolu, fatafā, etc.

23: matalua mā tolu

100: [?]

109: [?]

200-900: [?]

1000: [?]

11-19: matāgafulu mā tahi, matāgafulu mā lua, mā tolu, etc.

20-90: matalua, matatolu, fatafā, etc.

23: matalua mā tolu

100: [?]

109: [?]

200-900: [?]

1000: [?]

Vaka

1-9: tahi, lua, tolu, etc.

10: [?]

11-19: [?]

20-90: vaka luagafulu, vaka tolugafulu, vaka fāgafulu, etc.

45: vaka fāgafulu mo te vaka lima

100: [?]

Vaka / Canoes

1-9: tahi, lua, tolu, etc.

10: [?]

11-19: [?]

20-90: vaka luagafulu, vaka tolugafulu, vaka fāgafulu, etc.

45: vaka fāgafulu mo te vaka lima

100: [?]

Kolokolo, Kafa, Fakavaipua etc. "gafa"

1-9: gafa, gafa tahi, gafa lua, gafatolu, etc.

10: kumi

11-19: kumi mo te gafa tahi, kumi mo te gafa lua, etc.

20-90: luagakumi, tolugakumi, fāgakumu, etc.

100: lau

200-900: lua lau, toluga lau, fāgalau, etc.

1000: [?]

10,000: [?]

Kolokolo, Kafa, Fakavaipua etc. "gafa"

1-9: gafa, gafa tahi, gafa lua, gafatolu, etc.

10: kumi

11-19: kumi mo te gafa tahi, kumi mo te gafa lua, etc.

20-90: luagakumi, tolugakumi, fāgakumu, etc.

100: lau

200-900: lua lau, toluga lau, fāgalau, etc.

1000: [?]

10,000: [?]

Lau o Fale (pelā hoki mo epa, papa, kapau, tīpola, mo laugalegale) "kau"

1-9: mataimanu māhani, tahi, lua, tolu, fā, etc.

10: kau agafulu

11-19: kau agafulu mā tahi, kau agafulu mā lua, kau agafulu mā tolu etc.

20-90: kau lua, kau tolu, kau fā, etc.

100: kau telau

200-900: kau lualau, kau tolugalau, kau fāgalau, etc.

1000: kau afe, kau lua afe, kau tolu afe, etc.

Lau o Fale / Thatch panels (also epa, papa, kapau, tīpola, laugalegale) "kau"

1-9: mataimanu māhani, tahi, lua, tolu, fā, etc.

10: kau agafulu

11-19: kau agafulu mā tahi, kau agafulu mā lua, kau agafulu mā tolu etc.

20-90: kau lua, kau tolu, kau fā, etc.

100: kau telau

200-900: kau lualau, kau tolugalau, kau fāgalau, etc.

1000: kau afe, kau lua afe, kau tolu afe, etc.

10,000: kau agafulu afe

10,000: kau agafulu afe

Tauhaga o te Olaga o Tino (pelā mo te Mata o Muna 4) "fua"

35: fuatolu mā lima

50: fualima

80: fuavalu

100: tahi lau

Years of a Person's Life (see Chapter 4) "fua"

35: fuatolu mā lima

50: fualima

80: fuavalu

100: tahi lau

Pehea lā tauga o mea valevale ikonei?

• ika o te uluulu/papa? – e ia ai he vaega o tauga?? • kaukini, paipa (mea loaloa) – muna a tino, a 'pau mo tinā tauga, tahi, lua, etc • mea pāpā (laupapa, plywood, etc?) – muna a tino, a 'pau mo tinā tauga, tahi, lua, etc • pula lākau, pelā mo tiale, mo manogi o te fenua – muna a tino, a 'pau mo tinā tauga, tahi, lua, etc.

What about counting these things?

• Reef fish – are there special words for counting these? • Sticks, pipes (long things) – is just normal counting used? • Flat things (lumber, plywood, etc) – is just normal counting used for them (rather than the system used for other flat things like thatch panels, epa, papa and so on)? • Flowers such as hibiscus, and other decorative flowers/wreaths -- is just normal counting used for them?

Me e i ai ni vaega o tauga o mea ake hoki e 'tau o fakaopoopo i konei?

Are there counting categories for other things that should be added here?